BSU-IACUC User Manual

For reviewers: reviewing protocols and giving feedback

About this manual

Reviewers read submitted protocols, verify training certificates, mark up the document with comments, and either return the protocol for revision or finish the review. You can replay the interactive User Guide from the footer or the account menu, and the Page guide button on the Protocol Inbox.

1. Set up your account

1. Ask an administrator for a personnel registration link for the reviewer role. Links expire after 48 hours.
2. Open the link and complete the registration form. You receive an email that your application was received.
3. Wait for administrative staff to approve your account. Your account stays pending until then.
4. Sign in through the personnel sign-in page.

2. The Protocol Inbox

Dashboard opens the Protocol Inbox, which lists the protocols for you to review.

- **Search** by protocol title or the researcher's name.
- **Status filters** narrow the inbox. It opens on **To review**, which is your queue. The number next to each name is how many protocols have that status.
- **Certificates to verify** is the last pill in the status bar. It shows how many researchers are waiting for their training certificate to be verified. Press it to see who.
- **Sort** by newest or oldest submitted, or by title.
- **Status colors**: press the question mark at the end of the status bar to see what each status means for you.
- **Protocol card**: shows the status icon, research title, submission round, and researcher. Press the researcher's name to see their details and training certificate.
- **Pagination** at the bottom lets you move between pages and choose how many rows to show.

3. Verify a training certificate

Researchers upload their IACUC training certificate with their first protocol. You and administrative staff are notified, and either of you can verify it. A researcher only needs to be verified once.

1. Press **Certificates to verify**, or open the notification, and choose the researcher. You can also press the researcher's name on any protocol card.
2. In the researcher details, press **View certificate** and check that it is valid and belongs to the researcher.
3. Press **Verify** if it is acceptable. The researcher is notified.

4 Otherwise press **Request resubmission** and write what is wrong. A reason is required, and the researcher sees it by notification and email.

Every upload, verification, and rejection stays in the history with its note and the original file, so you can open earlier certificates at any time. A researcher who is rejected uploads a new file, and it returns to your list as pending.

> A protocol cannot be marked Reviewed until the researcher's certificate is verified. The system shows a message if it is not.

4. Review a protocol

1 Press **Review** on a protocol in To review. Protocols in other statuses show **View** instead, and **View Clearance** once approved.

2 Read the protocol in the viewer.

3 Draw an annotation box on the part of the document you want to comment on, and type your comment.

4 Edit or delete your comments as needed. Comments are what the researcher sees when the protocol is returned.

5. Make a decision

Decision	How it works
Return for revision	Use this when the researcher must fix something. Add any notes for the researcher. The protocol moves to Needs Revision and the researcher is notified. Only protocols under review can be returned.
Finish the review	Mark the protocol as Reviewed when your assessment is complete and the researcher's training certificate is verified. Protocol details are then added to the records automatically.

> A protocol cannot be marked Reviewed while it still has comments. Either return it for revision so the researcher can address them, or remove the comments to confirm that nothing is outstanding.

After the researcher resubmits, the protocol returns to Under Review. **Show History** lists every submission round, including the researcher's revisions.

6. What happens after review

Once you mark a protocol as Reviewed, administrative staff take over: payment verification, IPN, endorsement, and approval. You can follow the protocol's progress from the Dashboard and the Records page.

7. Records and statistics

- **Records** lists every protocol record. Search, filter by school, animal type, sex, researcher type, or status, and sort the list. Open a record's protocol file with the eye icon.
- **Statistics** shows review activity, record totals, and breakdowns for a period you choose, and **Download as Excel** exports them.

8. Other tools

- **Preview public site** in the header shows the site the way visitors see it.
- **Notifications**: the bell shows a badge when there is something new.
- Staff and reviewers can delete a protocol directly with the **Delete** button. Use it with care.

For anything else, use the Contact Us page or ask administrative staff.